Phishing Awareness Training

Protecting Our Organization from Cyber Threats

What is Phishing?

The Attack

Phishing is a cyberattack where attackers trick users into revealing sensitive information, clicking malicious links, or downloading harmful files.

The Disguise

Attackers impersonate trusted sources — banks, your IT team, or government agencies — to appear legitimate and lower your guard.

⚠ *Most cyberattacks start with phishing.*

Why Phishing Matters

Data Breaches

Sensitive company and customer data exposed to criminals.

Financial Loss

Fraudulent transfers and costly recovery efforts.

Identity Theft

Personal credentials stolen and misused.

System Compromise

Malware installed, granting attackers full access.

Types of Phishing Attacks

Email Phishing

Fake emails sent broadly to trick recipients into clicking links or sharing credentials.

Vishing

Voice call scams where attackers impersonate trusted figures over the phone.

Spear Phishing

Highly targeted attacks personalized to a specific individual or organization.

Clone Phishing

Legitimate emails are copied and resent with malicious links or attachments.

Smishing

SMS-based phishing using text messages with malicious links.

How to Recognize Phishing Emails

Red Flags to Watch For

- → ***Suspicious sender addresses*** *— mismatched or misspelled domains*
- → ***Urgent or threatening language*** *— pressure to act immediately*
- → ***Spelling and grammar mistakes*** *— unprofessional writing*
- → ***Unexpected attachments or links*** *— unsolicited files*
- → ***Requests for sensitive info*** *— passwords, bank details*

Social Engineering & Fake Websites

Emotional Manipulation Tactics

Urgency

"Act now or lose access!"

Fear

"Your account will be blocked."

Authority

"Message from your boss or IT."

Curiosity

"See this shocking news story."

Spotting Fake Websites

- *Check the URL for misspellings or strange domains*
- *Look for HTTPS 🔒 — but don't rely on it alone*
- *Watch for poor design or broken links*
- *Be wary of unexpected login pages asking for credentials*

ⓘ *Always navigate directly to websites rather than clicking email links.*

Real-World Phishing Examples

Fake Bank Email

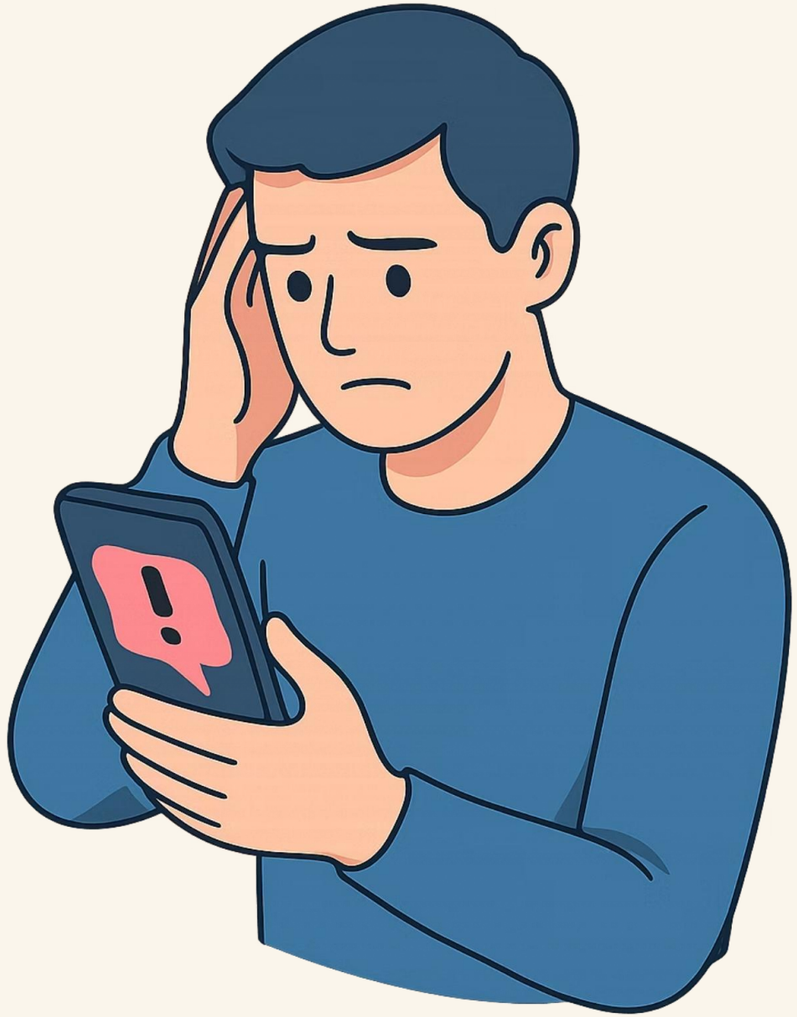
An email impersonating your bank asks you to verify login details via a fraudulent link.

"Package Delayed" SMS

A text message claims your delivery is delayed and includes a malicious tracking link.

CEO Fraud Email

An attacker impersonates your CEO, urgently requesting a wire transfer or sensitive data.



Best Practices & What To Do If Targeted

Best Practices to Stay Safe

- *Don't click suspicious links*
- *Verify the sender before responding*
- *Use multi-factor authentication (MFA)*
- *Keep all software updated*
- *Report suspicious emails immediately*

If You Suspect Phishing

⊗ *Do NOT click any links or download attachments.*

- *Report the message to your IT/security team*
- *Delete the message after reporting*
- *Change passwords if credentials were entered*

Quick Knowledge Check

Test your phishing awareness with these questions:

1

Which is a sign of phishing?

A. Personalized greeting B. Company logo C. Proper grammar
✅ ***D. Urgent request for your password***

2

What should you do with a suspicious email?

A. Click the link B. Ignore it D. Reply to sender
✅ ***C. Report it to IT immediately***

3

What is "smishing"?

A. Email attack C. Phone call scam D. Malware
✅ ***B. SMS-based phishing via text message***

Key Takeaways

Think Before You Click

Pause and verify every link and attachment before interacting.

Verify Before You Trust

Confirm sender identity through a separate, trusted channel.

Report Suspicious Activity

Always notify your IT/security team — never stay silent.

Stay Alert at All Times

Vigilance is your strongest defense against phishing.

> *"Cybersecurity is everyone's responsibility."*

Thank You!
STAY SAFE. STAY SECURE.